of institutions within China to comprehend the Chinese negotiating brief and basic position. The Chinese have been known to signal a shift in their position by using a different phrase or word to describe the same issue. This is their way of avoiding an open admission of compromise or surrender in a negotiation. It is good practice to, therefore, listen attentively and do a careful comparison of the words or phrases used in a negotiation with what has been used previously, to determine whether there is a change in the negotiating position.

In recent years, it seems that the dignified and gracious Chinese negotiator of yore may have been replaced by the assertive 'Wolf Warriors'. Of late, they tend to display aggression, arrogance, irritation and other disagreeable traits, but this is also theatre. The Chinese negotiators will utilize whatever posture they think is likely to advance their goal in a negotiation—victimhood, bonhomie and threat. This posture is usually scripted in advance of a negotiation. Words and gestures convey messages, not emotion. The Chinese negotiator is not interested in making friends for the sake of friendship. They build relationships with an eye on manipulation. The display of anger is also a put-on. The Chinese negotiator's objective is to gain psychological advantage over the opposite party before the beginning of any negotiation.

As the Chinese diplomats have become more proficient in the English language and in their sense of dress and deportment, the international community tends to regard them as 'one of us'. Chinese diplomats are not one of us. At the higher echelons, they are all members of the Communist Party of China, and owe their loyalty to the Party above the State. Diplomats in democracies act as agents of the government; Chinese diplomats act as agents of the Party. This is an important distinction. Chinese diplomats are ideological. Logic or reason is, therefore, not likely to convince the Chinese negotiator.